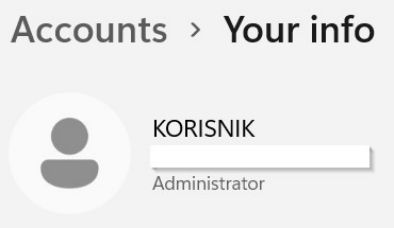
Ema Lovrić, 14.9.2026.

Assignment 20: Windows user accounts and access management

https://github.com/elovric13/eutech/tree/windows-user-accounts-and-access-management-elovric13

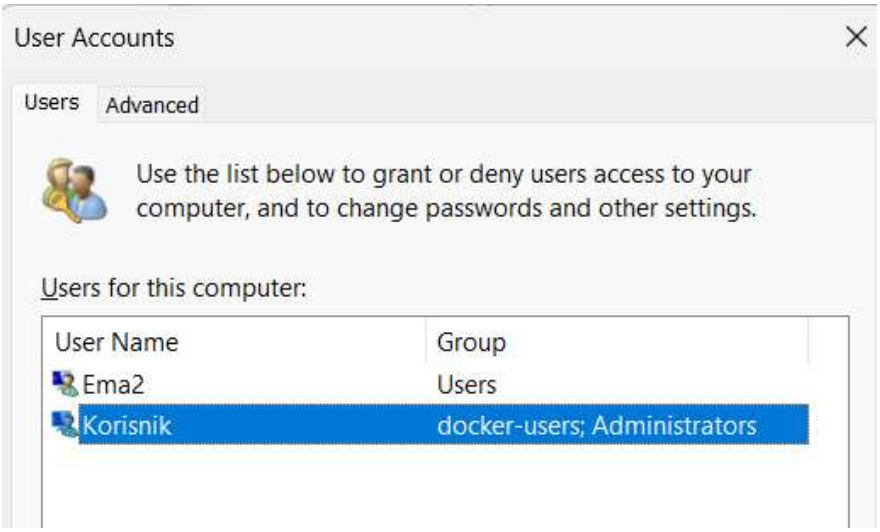
1. **Identify the user account currently being used on the computer**

The account currently in use is named KORISNIK. It is an Administrator account.



2. **Review the user accounts currently configured on the computer using Windows Settings or Control Panel.**

Two user accounts are configured on this computer. KORISNIK belongs to the docker-users and Administrators groups, giving it full administrative privileges. Ema2 belongs to the standard Users group only, meaning it has limited permissions and cannot make system-wide changes.



3. **Explain the main differences between an Administrator account and a Standard user account.**

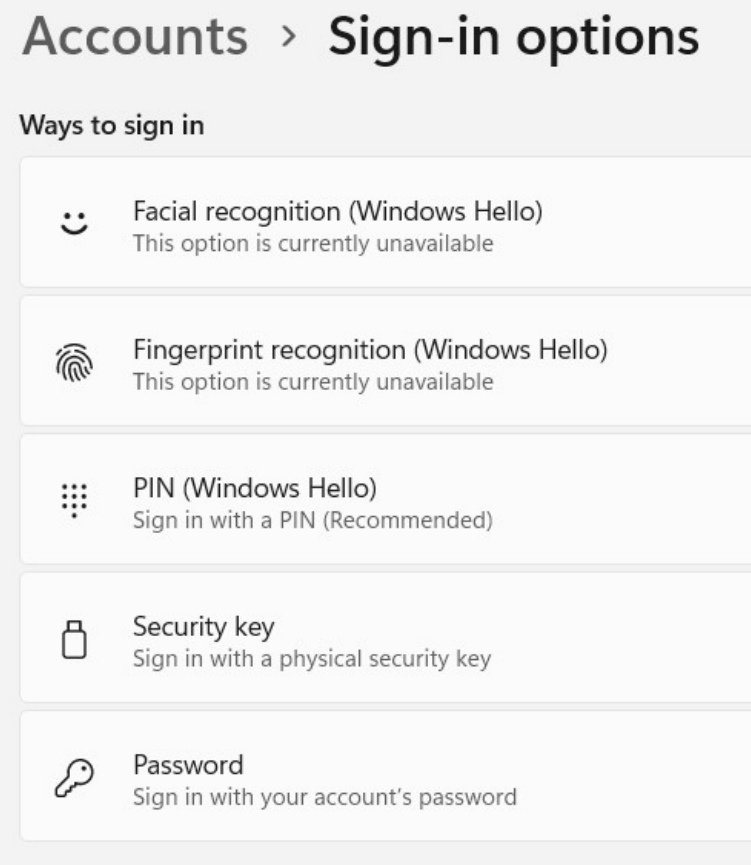
An Administrator account has full control over the system, it can install and uninstall software, change system settings, modify other user accounts, and access all files on the computer. A Standard user account is restricted to personal files and settings only. It cannot install software system-wide, change security settings, or access other users' files without authorization. Standard accounts are safer for

everyday use because malware or mistakes made under a standard account cannot affect the whole system.

4. **Review the current sign-in options available in Windows, such as: Password, PIN, Windows Hello, if available.**

The following sign-in methods are configured on this computer:

- Facial recognition (Windows Hello): unavailable – hardware not supported
- Fingerprint recognition (Windows Hello): unavailable – hardware not supported
- PIN (Windows Hello): available – recommended by Windows
- Security key: available – physical hardware key
- Password: available



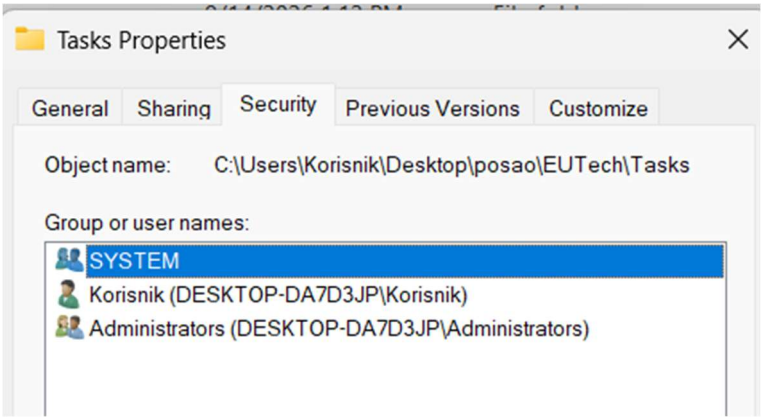
5. **Analyze the password and sign-in security options available on the computer.**

The computer has PIN set as the primary recommended sign-in method, which is a good security practice. A PIN is more secure than a password in this context because it is device-specific — it only works on this machine and is never transmitted over a network, unlike a password which could potentially be intercepted or reused across services. Windows Hello facial and fingerprint recognition are unavailable due to hardware limitations on this laptop. The security key option is available but not actively configured. Password remains as a fallback option. The absence of biometric authentication is a limitation but not a security concern given that PIN is in use.

6. **Select a personal test folder and review its current access permissions through Properties → Security.**

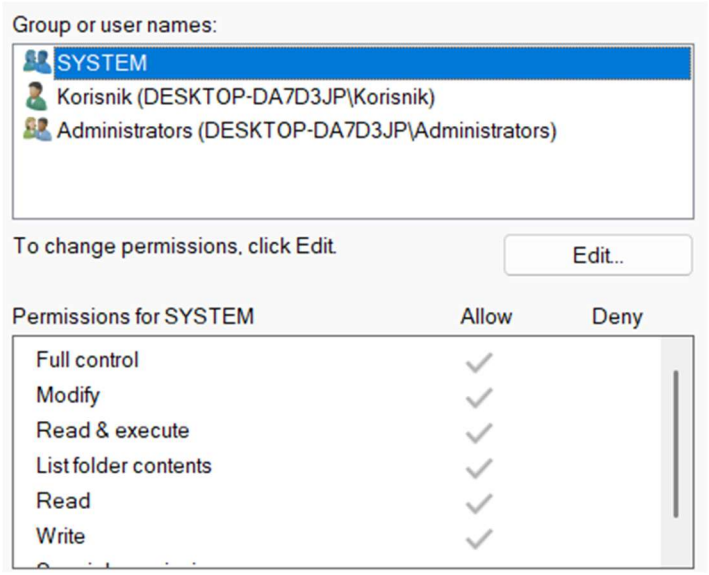
The selected folder for analysis is the Tasks folder. Three groups and users currently have access to this folder:

- SYSTEM
- Korisnik (DESKTOP-DA7D3JP\Korisnik)
- Administrators (DESKTOP-DA7D3JP\Administrators)

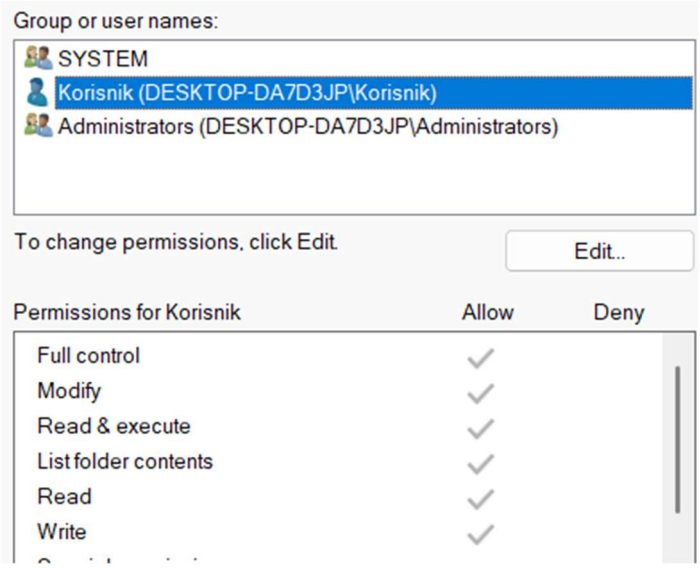


7. **Identify which users or system groups currently have access to the selected folder and record their permissions.**

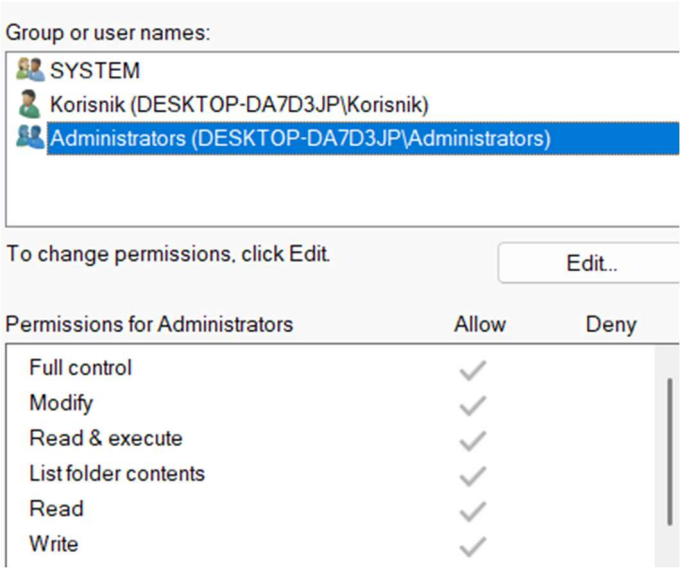
SYSTEM – Full control, Modify, Read & execute, List folder contents, Read, Write



Korisnik (DESKTOP-DA7D3JP\Korisnik) – Full control, Modify, Read & execute, List folder contents, Read, Write



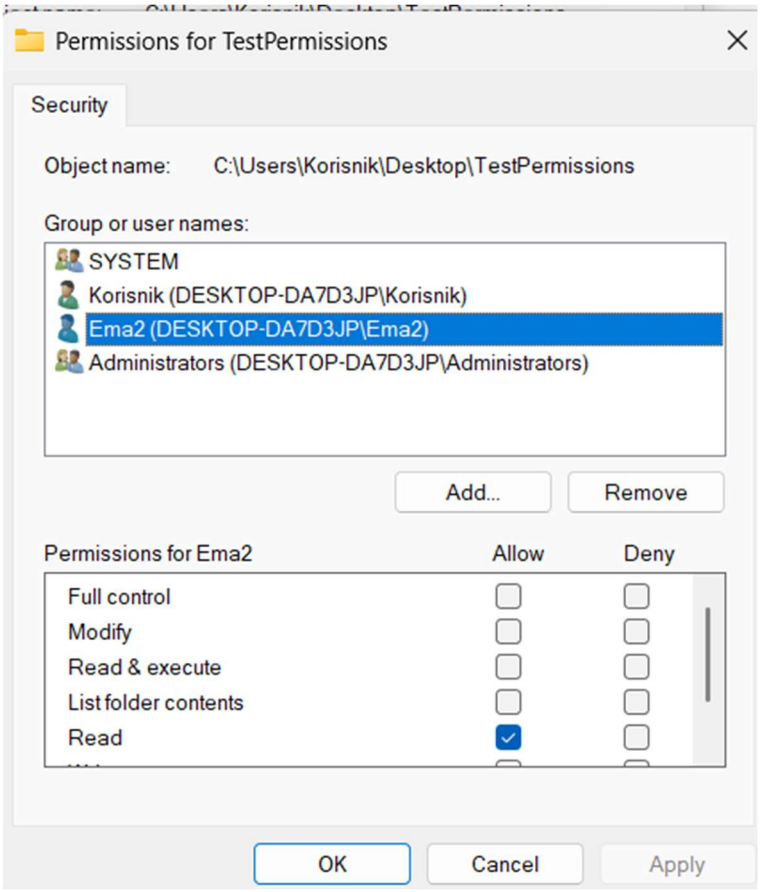
Administrators (DESKTOP-DA7D3JP\Administrators) – Full control, Modify, Read & execute, List folder contents, Read, Write



8. **Create a new test folder specifically for this task and review the available permission options. Test the effect of changing permissions on the test folder where possible. Do not modify permissions on Windows system folders or important personal files.**

A new folder named TestPermissions was created at C:\Users\Korisnik\Desktop\TestPermissions to test the available permission options in Windows. The following users and groups were present on the folder by default: SYSTEM, Korisnik, and Administrators – all with Full Control inherited from the parent folder. The Ema2 standard user account was then manually added.

Ema2 was granted only Read permission, with all other permissions (Full control, Modify, Read & execute, List folder contents, Write) left unchecked. This means Ema2 can open and view files inside the folder but cannot create new files, modify existing ones, or delete anything.



9. **Review the computer's automatic screen-lock and sign-in requirements.**

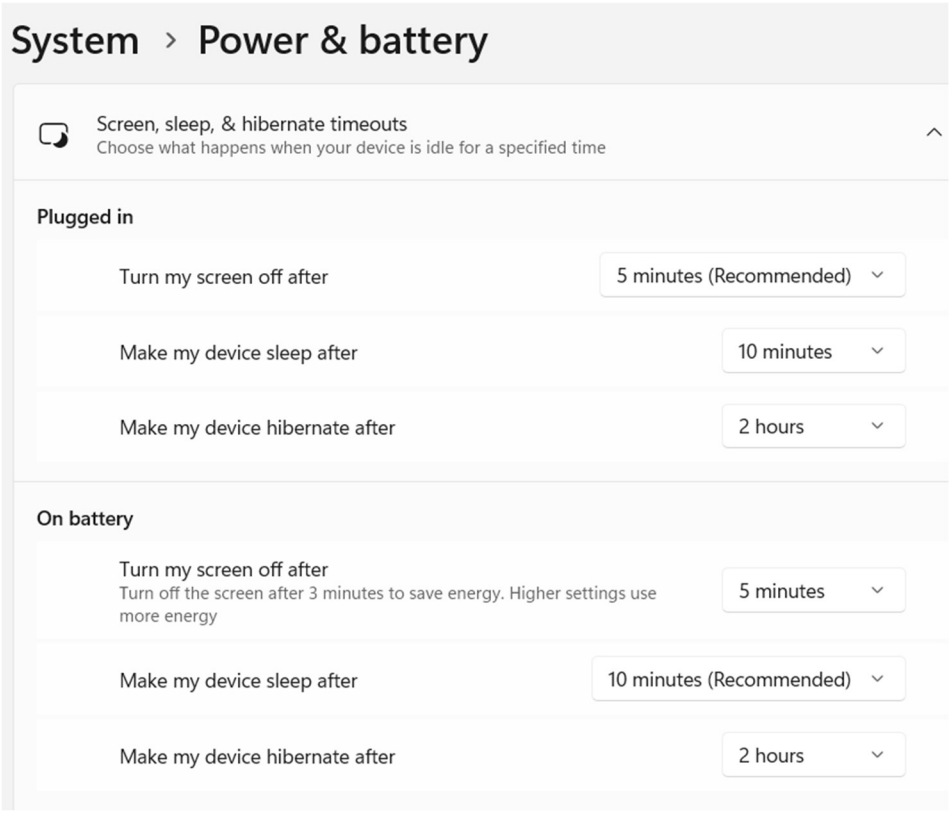
The computer is configured with the following automatic screen lock settings:

Plugged in:

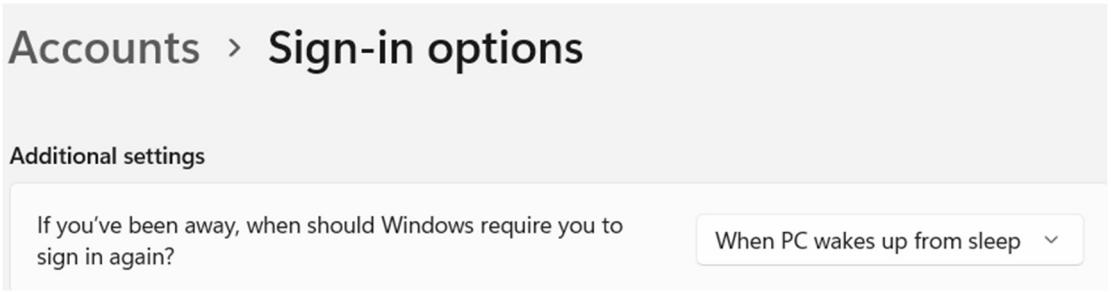
- Screen turns off after 5 minutes of inactivity
- Device sleeps after 10 minutes
- Device hibernates after 2 hours

On battery:

- Screen turns off after 5 minutes
- Device sleeps after 10 minutes
- Device hibernates after 2 hours.



Sign-in requirement after sleep:Windows is configured to require sign-in "When PC wakes up from sleep." This means every time the screen turns off and the device resumes, the user must authenticate before gaining access.



10. **Identify at least five good practices for managing user accounts and access permissions on a Windows computer.**

1. Use a standard user account for everyday tasks

Even if an Administrator account is available, daily work should be done from a standard user account. This limits the damage malware or accidental changes can cause a virus running under a standard account cannot modify system files or install software system-wide. The Administrator account should only be used when explicitly needed.

2. Use strong and unique passwords or PINs

Every user account should be protected with a strong password or PIN that is not reused across other services. A PIN is preferable for Windows sign-in as it is device-specific and never transmitted over a network. Passwords should be long, contain a mix of characters, and changed periodically.

3. Apply the principle of least privilege to folder permissions

Users and groups should only be granted the minimum permissions they need to do their work. As demonstrated in this task, Ema2 was given only Read access to the test folder rather than Full Control. Giving unnecessary Full Control to all users increases the risk of accidental or intentional data loss.

4. Regularly review user accounts and remove unused ones

Over time, accounts accumulate on a system, former users, test accounts, or temporary accounts that are never deleted. Each unused account is a potential entry point for unauthorized access. User accounts should be reviewed periodically and any account no longer in use should be disabled or removed.

5. Enable automatic screen lock with sign-in required on wake

As configured on this computer, the screen should automatically lock after a short period of inactivity and require authentication when resuming. This prevents unauthorized physical access when the computer is left unattended, which is particularly important in shared workspaces or public environments.